

CUSTOMER & MVP

Blueprint

AI-Powered Career Preparation Platform

Source: **Startup Validation Report — Extracted & Enhanced**

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Sector: **EdTech · AI · Career Intelligence**

Scope: **Customer Research + MVP Specification**

Market: **India First then Global**

SECTION 01

Executive Summary

Extracted from the Startup Validation Report and enhanced with product-layer analysis. This blueprint specifies who to build for, what to build first, what to skip, and how to measure success — structured as a working PM document.

78/100	82/100	71/100	55/100	MVP Readiness
YELLOW	INR 299-499	4 Weeks	India	Launch Market

Key Takeaways

- Strong problem-solution fit. Execution paralysis and roadmap confusion are real, high-severity pains.
- No validated demand yet. Peer conversations are signal, not proof. 20 structured interviews must happen before any code.
- MVP must deliver one magic moment in under 2 minutes: input career goal, receive personalised daily plan.
- Freemium is the right entry model. Paywall at project recommendations and mock interview access.
- Biggest build risk: over-scoping. Ship the roadmap generator first. Everything else is Phase 2.

SECTION 02

Ideal Customer Profile (ICP)

Dimension	Profile	Why It Matters
Age	18-25 (primary); 25-30 career switchers (secondary)	18-25 segment has highest urgency + lowest switching cost
Education	B.Tech / BCA / BSc Engineering, 2nd-4th year or recent grad	Active placement anxiety; campus networks for acquisition
Location	Tier 1 & 2 India: Delhi, Bengaluru, Hyderabad, Pune, Jaipur	High internet penetration; strong MAANG aspiration culture
Target Role	Data Analyst, Data Scientist, ML Engineer, SWE	Non-SWE tracks underserved by Scaler/AlmaBetter
Budget	INR 300-500/month disposable for self-improvement	Validates sub-INR 499 pricing; below Zomato threshold
Behaviour	Has bookmarked 5+ courses; abandoned 3+; GitHub has 0-2 projects	Proven intent + proven failure = highest conversion probability
Device	Android smartphone primary; laptop secondary	Mobile-first UX is non-negotiable for India market
Pain Trigger	Peer gets internship, placement season, failed interview	Design acquisition campaigns around these exact moments

SECTION 03

Buyer Persona

ARJUN SHARMA, 21 B.Tech CSE, 3rd Year — Jaipur Target: Data Analyst / ML Engineer Budget: INR 300-500/month		Quote: "I know I need to learn Python and SQL, but every time I sit down to study I end up watching another roadmap video instead of actually building something."	
Goals	Frustrations	A Day in His Life	Channels
Land DA internship by final year Get 6-10 LPA package Build 3 GitHub projects Clear technical interviews	Watches 10 videos; builds 0 Python vs SQL paralysis Abandoned Coursera at week 2 Feels behind sorted peers	AM: LinkedIn scroll, FOMO PM: Opens 3 tabs, closes all Evening: Job story videos Night: Saves roadmap posts	LinkedIn, YouTube Reddit: r/developersIndia Discord (DS India) College WhatsApp groups

SECTION 04

Top 10 Customer Pain Points

#	Severity	Pain Point	Description
01	CRITICAL	Planning Over Doing	70%+ of study time spent researching what to study, not studying. Core value prop must attack this.
02	CRITICAL	Roadmap Paralysis	Conflicting roadmaps online with no personalised guidance. Students freeze between options.
03	CRITICAL	Zero Execution Feedback	No signal of progress. No benchmark. No external validation that they are improving.
04	HIGH	Project Ideas Vacuum	Know they need projects. Don't know what to build at their current level. Generic lists fail them.
05	HIGH	Accountability Desert	90%+ MOOC dropout rate. No one to answer to. No streak. No consequence for skipping a day.
06	HIGH	Interview Prep Fragmentation	Resume, mock interviews, DSA, and system design live on 4 different platforms with no unified flow.
07	MEDIUM	Impostor Syndrome Loop	Daily LinkedIn scroll amplifies feeling of being behind. No system to measure actual progress.
08	MEDIUM	Resource Quality Noise	Cannot distinguish good courses from bad. Too much choice creates decision paralysis, not progress.
09	MEDIUM	Skill-to-Job Gap Blindspot	Learns skills in isolation with no understanding of how they map to actual job requirements.
10	LOW	Isolation of Solo Learning	No community accountability. No peers at same stage. No shared progress milestones.

SECTION 05

Customer Journey Map

Stage	User Action	Platform Response	Metric to Track
AWARE	Peer gets internship; stumbles on LinkedIn post about learning paralysis	Relatable founder content; 'I was you 6 months ago' storytelling	Impressions, CTR, landing page visits
CONSIDER	Reads platform value prop; sees 'Generate your roadmap in 2 minutes'	Free instant roadmap with no signup wall; clear before/after	Signups, time-on-page, scroll depth
TRIAL	Enters goal; receives personalised daily plan; feels immediate relief	Magic moment under 2 min; daily email/WhatsApp nudge activated	Activation rate, D1 return, plan completion
PURCHASE	Hits paywall: project recommendations or mock interview access	One-click INR 299 upgrade; no credit card required for trial	Free-to-paid conversion, payment success
RETAIN	7-day streak; shares progress card on LinkedIn; completes first project	Streak mechanics; shareable badges; weekly progress digest	D7/D30 retention, streak length, projects built
ADVOCATE	Refers 2+ friends; applies to be campus ambassador	Referral bonus (1 month free); paid ambassador programme	Referral rate, NPS, ambassador count

SECTION 06

Objections & Buying Triggers

Buying Triggers

- Peer lands internship (FOMO) — single highest-converting moment
- Placement season approaching — deadline urgency is your best ad
- Failed a technical interview — recovery state = maximum openness to paid tools
- Completed a free course, nothing changed — proof that free is not enough
- College placement cell fails them — institutional trust collapses, external trust rises

Objection	Root Cause	Counter (Product + Copy)
"YouTube is free"	Price anchor	YouTube gives knowledge. We give completion. Show a "before/after streak" screenshot.

Objection	Root Cause	Counter (Product + Copy)
"Will start next month"	Procrastination	"Your next placement drive is in X weeks." Auto-calculate and show on landing page.
"Don't trust AI advice"	Trust deficit	Human-reviewed roadmaps badge. Show 5 peer names + outcomes. Free trial first.
"Already have a roadmap"	Status quo bias	Ask "How many days did you follow it last month?" Silence is the counter.
"Can't afford it"	Budget	INR 299 = 1 Zomato order. Freemium forever tier with daily plan access.
"Not sure it'll work"	Risk aversion	14-day money-back guarantee. Case study of 1 real beta user from your college.

SECTION 07

MVP Recommendation

What to Build First — The Magic Moment Feature

The MVP has one job: deliver a personalised, actionable daily learning plan within 2 minutes of a user entering their career goal. Everything else is Phase 2.

BUILD FIRST	DO NOT BUILD YET
Career goal input (role + timeline + current level) AI-generated personalised roadmap (week-by-week) Daily task feed (3 tasks per day, 30-60 min each) Progress tracker (simple checklist + streak counter) Freemium paywall at project recommendations Email / WhatsApp daily nudge	Full interview simulator Resume builder Peer community / forums Mentor marketplace Mobile app (web-first, then app) Certifications or badges Corporate / B2B dashboard Multi-language support

MVP Success Metrics

Metric	Target	Timeframe	Meaning if Hit
Waitlist signups	100+	Week 4	Problem is real; people want a solution
D1 Activation (roadmap generated)	>60%	MVP launch	Magic moment is working
D7 Retention	>30%	Week 1 post-launch	Daily habit is forming
Free-to-paid conversion	>5%	Month 1	Willingness to pay confirmed
NPS score	>40	Month 1	Advocacy potential is real
Customer interviews completed	20	Week 1	Validation, not assumption, drives build

SECTION 08

MoSCoW Prioritisation

MUST HAVE
● Career goal + current level input form
● AI-generated week-by-week personalised roadmap
● Daily 3-task action feed (30-60 min per task)
● Streak tracker + simple completion checklist
● Freemium paywall: project recommendations gated
● Email or WhatsApp daily nudge (pick one for MVP)
● Mobile-responsive web interface
SHOULD HAVE
● Project recommendation engine (first paid feature)
● Basic mock interview Q&A; (text-based, AI-scored)
● Shareable progress card (LinkedIn-optimised)
● Referral system (1 month free per referral)
● Onboarding quiz to refine roadmap accuracy
COULD HAVE
● Peer leaderboard and community feed
● Resource library (curated, not created)
● Campus ambassador dashboard
● Progress analytics (skills radar chart)
● Employer-side profile visibility toggle
WON'T HAVE (NOW)

● Native iOS / Android apps
● Live mentor sessions or 1:1 coaching
● Resume builder or ATS scanner
● Corporate / B2B admin dashboard
● Multi-language support
● AI voice assistant

SECTION 09

Pricing Hypothesis

Tier	Price	Includes	Goal
Free Forever	INR 0	Career goal input, AI roadmap, daily plan for 7 days, streak tracker	Activation + habit formation. Get them to the magic moment.
Explorer	INR 299/mo	Unlimited daily plans, project recommendations (3/month), basic mock interview Q&A;	First conversion. Prove willingness to pay.
Accelerator	INR 499/mo	Everything + unlimited projects, full interview prep, progress analytics, shareable badge	Power user retention. 60-70% of revenue from this tier.
Campus Pack	INR 199/mo per seat (min 20)	Accelerator for all; admin dashboard for placement cell	B2B validation. One college = 20 guaranteed users.

Pricing Rationale

- INR 299 is below psychological resistance. Less than one Zomato order per week.
- Annual plans (INR 2,499 / INR 3,999) should be offered at ~30% discount to improve cash flow.
- Do not offer a free trial period -- use a freemium forever tier instead. Trials expire and create churn friction.
- Test INR 199 vs INR 299 in week 4 landing page A/B test before committing.

SECTION 10

Top 5 Risks

#	Risk	Scenario	Mitigation
01	Building Before Validating	No structured customer interviews completed. MVP built on assumptions fails faster than validated products.	Run 20 interviews in Week 1. Do not write code until interview 15 confirms the problem.
02	Over-Scoping the MVP	Adding resume builder, community, and interview simulator before roadmap feature has retention.	Freeze scope at the MoSCoW Must Have list. Reject all other features until D30 retention exceeds 30%.
03	AI Accuracy Killing Trust	A hallucinated roadmap recommendation destroys trust permanently with an early user.	Human-reviewed roadmap templates for top 5 roles. AI customises; humans verify the base.
04	Monetisation Resistance	Students may use free tier indefinitely and never convert.	Design freemium with a clear value cliff. Free = 7 days. Paid = ongoing. Make the limit visible.
05	Solo Founder Burnout	Validating, building, and marketing simultaneously is unsustainable solo.	Time-box ruthlessly. 4 hrs/day on product. Recruit 1 campus intern for outreach by Week 3.

SECTION 11

30-Day MVP Plan

Week 1 Customer Validation

- Run 20 structured discovery interviews (strangers, not friends)
- Ask: 'Walk me through the last time you tried to learn a new skill for your career'
- Document verbatim quotes; build affinity map of top 3 pain points
- Identify 3 users willing to be beta testers
- Deliverable: Pain point ranking document + 5 confirmed beta users

Week 2 Competitor & Gap Research

- Sign up and actively use Scaler, AlmaBetter, Roadmap.sh for 3+ days each
- Map exact feature gap: what does none of them do that interviews confirmed users want?
- Write 1-paragraph positioning statement: 'For [ICP], unlike [competitor], we [unique value]'
- Deliverable: Competitor gap matrix + positioning statement

Week 3 MVP Scoping + Wireframe

- Define single magic moment: input goal, receive daily plan in under 2 minutes
- Wireframe 3 screens only: Goal Input, Roadmap View, Daily Task Feed
- Write user story: 'As Arjun, I want to... so that I...' under 200 words
- Decide tech stack: Next.js + OpenAI API or no-code (Bubble/FlutterFlow) for speed
- Deliverable: Wireframe + tech decision + user story doc

Week 4 Landing Page + Waitlist Launch

- Build landing page on Carrd, Typedream, or Framer (no-code, 1 day max)
- Headline must reference the magic moment: 'Your personalised learning plan in 2 minutes'
- Add waitlist form (Tally or Typeform), capture email + target role
- Share in 5 WhatsApp groups, 3 Discord servers, 2 LinkedIn posts, 1 Reddit thread
- Deliverable: 100+ waitlist signups. If under 50 by Day 28, pivot the messaging.

SECTION 12

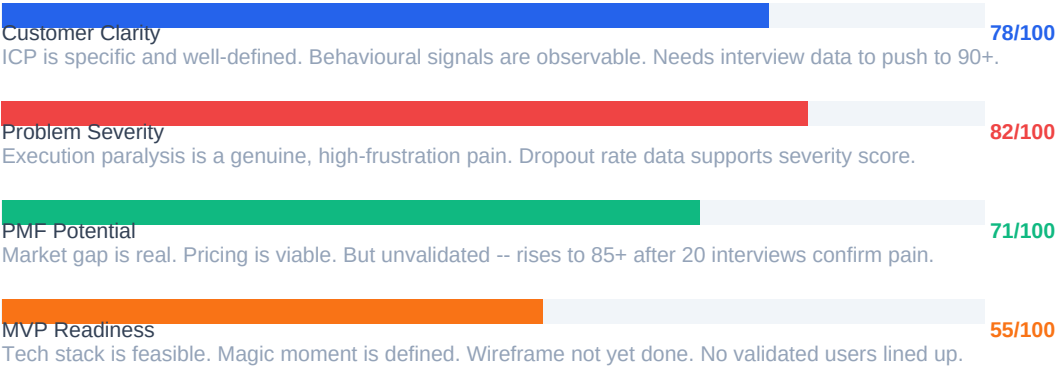
Founder Action Sheet — Top 10 Next Actions

#	Action	Owner	Deadline	Done?
01	Write 20 customer interview questions; schedule first 5 interviews	You	Day 2	☐
02	Create a Notion doc to log all interview quotes verbatim	You	Day 1	☐
03	Sign up for Scaler, AlmaBetter, Roadmap.sh; use each for 3 days	You	Day 3	☐
04	Write your positioning statement (1 paragraph, no jargon)	You	Day 7	☐
05	Wireframe 3 MVP screens on Figma or paper; share with 2 beta users	You	Day 14	☐
06	Decide: build with code (Next.js + OpenAI) or no-code (Bubble)	You	Day 10	☐
07	Build landing page (1 day max; use Carrd or Typedream)	You	Day 22	☐
08	Write 3 LinkedIn posts; 1 must be a raw founder story about your own paralysis	You	Day 5	☐
09	Identify 1 campus intern or friend to help with outreach; brief them	You	Day 7	☐
10	Set up a simple analytics tool (Mixpanel free or PostHog) before launch	You	Day 20	☐

SECTION 13

Scores & Final Verdict

Dimension Scores



● YEL
LOW

Promising but Unvalidated

Strong signals across problem severity, market gap, and founder fit. The idea has real merit. The execution gap is real. The competitive window is open.

Condition to upgrade to Green: Complete 20 customer interviews + 100 waitlist signups. If both are hit, this moves to Strong Demand Signal and MVP build is authorised.

What Changes This Verdict

- GREEN if: 20 interviews confirm execution paralysis as top-3 pain AND 100+ waitlist signups achieved.
- ORANGE if: Interviews reveal the problem is less severe than assumed OR pricing resistance is high.
- RED if: Waitlist under 30 after active promotion OR users say 'I already have a system that works'.
- This verdict upgrades automatically when evidence arrives. The idea is not the risk. The build-before-validate pattern is.

Generated by AI Product Studio using Steve Blank's Customer Discovery, YC's Do Things That Don't Scale, and Marty Cagan's Continuous Discovery frameworks. Extracted from Startup Validation Report (June 2026). All figures are estimates and must be independently validated.